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Members of the Warner School Admissions Committee
Warner School of Education
University of Rochester

Dear Members of the Warner School Admissions Committee,

I am writing to express my enthusiastic application for the Master's in Teaching program with Initial Certification in K-12 Computer Science at the Warner School of Education. I am particularly excited about the opportunity to pursue this program through the Noyce Scholarship, which aligns closely with my passion for computer science education and my commitment to teaching in high-need schools.

I hold a Master's degree in Computer Science from Rochester Institute of Technology, as well as a Bachelor's degree in Computer Engineering from Farmingdale State College. Additionally, I am currently completing a Master's program in Data Science at RIT, which serves as a bridging program to enhance my research skills and prepare for a future PhD. I have two semesters remaining in this program. However, my immediate focus is on finding effective ways to make a positive impact in high-need schools as quickly as possible, by leveraging the resources and mentorship provided through the Noyce Scholarship program.

My professional journey since graduation has included roles in data science, software engineering, interdisciplinary research, and tutoring. While these experiences strengthened my technical expertise, they also confirmed my desire to create a positive impact through teaching. Working as a tutor with Varsity Tutors, mentoring students in various STEM disciplines, deepened my commitment to creating equitable learning opportunities and fostering an inclusive environment where all students can thrive. I firmly believe that teaching K-12 Computer Science can inspire students to embrace critical thinking, creativity, and problem-solving skills that are essential in today's technology-driven world. This realization has motivated me to pursue a career where I can directly empower students in high-need schools, fostering critical thinking and creating opportunities where they are most needed.

The Warner School's commitment to preparing educators to effectively implement the New York State Computer Science and Digital Fluency standards resonates with my own aspirations. I am excited by the prospect of developing the skills and pedagogical knowledge necessary to foster inclusive and effective

computer science education within high-need schools. The additional coursework and mentorship opportunities offered by the Noyce Scholarship will be invaluable as I work toward becoming a dedicated and impactful educator.

Furthermore, I am eager to fulfill the Noyce Scholarship's requirement of teaching in a high-need school for at least two years within four years of graduating from the program. I view this commitment not only as a scholarship obligation but as a personal mission to make a meaningful difference where it is most needed.

Thank you very much for considering my application. I look forward to the possibility of joining the Warner School community and contributing to the Noyce Scholarship's vision of preparing the next generation of STEM educators.

Sincerely,

Piter Garcia